On what basis FieldNote recommends.

A recommendation is only worth trusting if you can see how it was reached. Every card is scored on four axes, then mapped to an action by a fixed rule. Nothing rests on opinion or a vendor's press release.

1 · Evidence grade — how well substantiated

A	Independent production evidence — named organisation, method, measurable result. Language: "observed in production".
B	Named customer case study or credible research with clear methodology. Language: "reported / associated with".
C	Vendor documentation, release notes or sponsored study. Language: "vendor states".
D	Demo, announcement or unverified secondary report. Language: "early signal, not verified".

2 · Verified outcome — what actually happened

The vendor's claim is checked against outcomes FieldNote has tracked across real pilots. The gap between claim and verified reality is itself the intelligence — and the proprietary asset a summary can't reproduce.

3 · Fit to your business

Does it address a stated priority, and are the conditions where it works present at your company? A strong average outcome with poor fit is still the wrong bet.

4 · Complexity & risk

Implementation effort, downside exposure and reversibility.

The decision rule

ADOPT	Strong evidence (A/B) + consistent positive verified outcome + good fit + low downside.
PILOT	Positive but variable outcome, or strong fit on a high-effort response — prove it in your context against a control before rollout.
INVESTIGATE	Real potential on vendor-grade (C) evidence — get methodology and references, then a small controlled test.
WATCH	Weak evidence or a negative track record — do not act; the downside outweighs the upside.

Note: pilot counts and verified figures in this sample dossier are illustrative. In production they are drawn from FieldNote's tracked-outcomes ledger, which accrues with every customer pilot.

INDEPENDENT BENCHMARK · 15 SEP 2026

ML invalid-traffic detection outperforms rule-based filters

Recommend: Adopt | **Evidence B** | Ad operations | Revenue

Why Adopt: Grade-B independent evidence, a consistent positive outcome (+6% net revenue recovered across 27 pilots) and low downside → the risk-adjusted case is strong enough to roll out, not just test.

CLAIM → VERIFIED

~~Vendor: "catches 99% of invalid traffic"~~ → **+6% net revenue recovered, median, 27 tracked publishers; low downside**

WHAT HAPPENED	Catches sophisticated invalid traffic that rule-based filters miss, protecting revenue and advertiser trust.
TRACK RECORD	Consistent, low-drama win across 27 tracked publishers — one of the few "adopt" grades precisely because the downside stayed small. Best fit: broadly applicable, more upside at higher programmatic volume.
COMPANY RELEVANCE	Broadly relevant; IVT quietly taxes programmatic revenue and standing with demand partners.
REQUIREMENTS	Pre-bid integration · traffic logs · demand-partner alignment.
KEY RISKS	False positives suppressing good traffic · latency.
SUCCESS MEASURES	IVT rate · blocked-good rate · advertiser complaints · net revenue.
EVIDENCE & SOURCES	Independent benchmark with reproducible method.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Roll out ahead of the ad server; start in flag-only mode to calibrate false positives, then enable blocking; measure recovered revenue against a hold-back.